POWER BI & DATA ANALYTICS PAST CERTIFICATION & INTERVIEW PAPERS (2023 - 2025)

Question 1 (2024 Exam • 4 Marks):
Compare Import mode and DirectQuery mode in Power BI. Which storage mode uses the VertiPaq in-memory engine and why would an organization still choose DirectQuery?

Question 2 (2024 Exam • 3 Marks):
What is the difference between Merge Queries and Append Queries in Power Query? Which SQL operations do they correspond to?

Question 3 (2023 Exam • 5 Marks):
Explain the Star Schema design pattern in Power BI. Distinguish clearly between Fact tables and Dimension tables, and explain why bi-directional cross-filtering should generally be avoided.

Question 4 (2025 Exam • 5 Marks):
Differentiate between a Calculated Column and a Measure in DAX in terms of evaluation context (Row vs Filter context), storage in RAM, and appropriate use cases.

Question 5 (2024 Exam • 4 Marks):
Why is CALCULATE() considered the most important function in DAX? Write a DAX expression using CALCULATE and ALL() to find each product’s percentage of total sales.

Question 6 (2025 Exam • 4 Marks):
Explain the difference between Static Row-Level Security (RLS) and Dynamic RLS. Which DAX function enables Dynamic RLS, and which workspace role users bypass RLS?

Question 7 (2023 Exam • 3 Marks):
What are the mandatory requirements for a dedicated Date table in Power BI when using Time Intelligence functions like SAMEPERIODLASTYEAR()?

Question 8 (2025 Exam • 3 Marks):
What is Query Folding in Power Query, and why does breaking query folding slow down dataset refreshes?